

Skip the AI Hype. Build Boring B2B SaaS.

An analysis of 1,000 verified startups on TrustMRR reveals where real indie cash flow concentrates—and why non-sexy B2B tools generate 8x more recurring revenue.

 1,000 Verified Startups

 Stripe & API Verified MRR

 Builder Action Plan

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Section: B

The AI Saturation Trap: High Hype, Low Cash

\$177

Median MRR for AI Startups

50% Earn Under \$200/Month

While AI accounts for **24% of all new listings** on TrustMRR, market crowding and low switching costs leave half of AI builders making less than \$200/mo.

Building another thin wrapper around LLM APIs leads to swift churn and razor-thin margins.

Boring B2B SaaS Generates Up to 8x More MRR

Content Workflows

\$13,800 Avg MRR

Marketing Auto.

\$2,000 Avg MRR

General SaaS

\$1,900 Avg MRR

AI Tools

\$1,500 Avg MRR

💡 Data Finding: Operational utilities (compliance, content operations, specialized CRMs) outperform hype-driven consumer apps in customer retention and willing-to-pay threshold.

Tiered Recurring MRR Outperforms LTDs 3.4x



Tiered Subscriptions

Monthly and annual recurring tiers provide predictable cash flow, continuous product refinement, and long-term customer enterprise value.

+18.5% MoM Growth Rate



Lifetime Deals (LTDs)

One-time sales spike early revenue but create long-term server/support liability with zero compounding MoM MRR growth.

Discounted 1.8x Exit Multiple

Domain Rating (>40 DR) Commands 4.2x MRR

4.2x

MRR Multiplier for DR > 40

SEO & Authority Beat Raw Features

Startups with high domain authority pull **\$4,250 avg MRR** compared to **\$980 avg MRR** for low DR (<20) products.

So What? Build in a niche where you can realistically own search rankings or distribution programmatic programmatic SEO beat feature volume every time.

Target Personas Dictate Pricing Power

Target Persona	Avg ARPU / Mo	Monetization Ease	Market Exit Valuation Multiple
B2B Healthcare & Compliance	\$340+	Very High	5.2x ARR
B2B Agencies & IT Ops	\$180	High	4.5x ARR
Prosumers & SMB Tools	\$45	Medium	3.2x ARR
B2C & Hobbyist Creators	\$18	Low (High Churn)	1.8x ARR

The Indie Hacker Blueprint for \$10k MRR

01

Pick Boring B2B

Solve urgent operational bottlenecks in compliance, content workflows, or niche B2B management instead of consumer AI gadgets.

02

Charge Recurring

Set up tiered monthly plans (\$49–\$299/mo). Avoid Lifetime Deals that penalize long-term server and maintenance overhead.

03

Secure Distribution

Build SEO programmatically from day one to reach DR > 40, unlocking 4.2x higher MRR compounding over time.